



RECORDS MANAGEMENT & RETENTION POLICY

Creation, storage, access, retention, and destruction of all program records — service records are never destroyed

Document Reference	ECC-REC-POL-2026-001
Version / Effective Date	1.0 — July 2026
Approved By	Executive Director
Review Date	July 1, 2027 (annual)
Applies To	All Evergreen Community Care programs — MCFD (children & youth) and CLBC (adult) streams
Legislative / Standards Basis	MCFD SHSS E.7, H.1.4 (rev. April 2026); CLBC contract record standards; CFCSA; RCR s.47; CDSA; FOIPPA/PIPA; BC Employment Standards Act; Income Tax Act (CRA); WorkSafeBC

1. Policy Statement

Evergreen Community Care creates accurate, complete, and timely records of its services and operations; stores them securely and confidentially; retains them for at least the periods in Section 3; and destroys records only where destruction is permitted, using the controlled procedure in Section 6.

Individual service records of children, youth, and adults in care are NEVER destroyed — they belong to the director (MCFD stream) or are governed by the CLBC contract, and on program closure they are transferred to the funder, never discarded.

2. Roles and Responsibilities

All staff	Create records same-shift per the Documentation Standards (ECC-STAFF-BND-2026-001 Part 6); never remove, photograph, or transmit records off-site; report suspected loss or breach same day
Program Coordinator (PC)	Maintains individual service records (SHSS E.7.10 contents), medication records, and program logs; controls the records storage area; runs the retention schedule; prepares transfer packages
Program Manager (PM)	Audits service records quarterly; approves any destruction (Section 6); manages funder and legal access requests; maintains personnel records
Executive Director (ED)	Owns this policy; approves the annual retention schedule review; signs destruction authorizations; responds to FOIPPA/PIPA and legal demands with counsel

3. Retention Schedule

Periods below are ECC minimums and meet or exceed statutory minimums. Where two periods could apply, the longer applies. A litigation hold, funder direction, or investigation suspends ALL destruction for the affected records.

Record Category	Retention Period	Authority / Note
Individual service record (intake, legal, medical/dental, consents, care plans, day book, complaints, incidents, termination summary)	NEVER destroyed	SHSS E.7 — belongs to the director; transfer to funder on closure
Medication Administration Records (MAR) + medication profiles	Care + 7 years	ECC-MED-2026-001 §6.1
MAR where any controlled substance (CDS) administered; CDS count sheets; disposal records	Care + 10 years	ECC-MED-2026-001 §6.1, App G; CDSA
Reportable / critical incident reports; restraint records	With service record — never destroyed	SHSS C.2.8, C.3, E.7.10
Medication error reports + root cause analyses	10 years	ECC-MED App D; QA trail
Daily logs / wellness checks (program copies)	Filed to service record — never destroyed	SHSS C.1.11–.12, E.7
Personnel records (screening, CRC result letters, references, evaluations, discipline, training)	Employment + 7 years	SHSS G.1.10; exceeds ESA minimums
Payroll and timekeeping records	Minimum 4 years from creation (ECC standard: 7 years)	BC ESA s.28
Financial records, ledgers, invoices, bank statements	7 years (6-year CRA minimum + 1)	Income Tax Act; ECC-FIN-POL-2026-001
Insurance policies and certificates	Permanent (policy documents); claims files 10 years after closure	SHSS H.1.9; ECC-INS-REG-2026-001
Fire drill, facility inspection, temperature, key, and visitor logs	7 years	SHSS F.4; funder review trail
First aid records (staff injuries)	Minimum 3 years	WorkSafeBC OHS Regulation
Contracts and funder agreements	Term + 7 years	SHSS H.1.4
Complaint records (non-client-specific)	7 years; client-specific copies to service record	SHSS B.2
Policy manuals — superseded versions	Permanent archive of each version (one copy)	Evidences the rules in force at any date

4. Storage and Security

Active records	Stored in the designated locked cabinet/room at the program; never left out; never in vehicles overnight; medication records in the medication area per ECC-MED-2026-001
Confidential handling	CRC results and medical information stored in sealed/segregated sections with access limited to PM/ED
Electronic records	Program devices only; unique logins; no client information on personal devices, email, or messaging apps; backups per IT procedure; same retention rules apply
Off-site / archive	Closed records boxed, indexed, and stored in the locked archive; the index records box number, contents, dates, and destruction-eligible date (or NEVER for service records)
Access	Staff access on a need-to-know basis; youth/adults may access their own records with support (SHSS B.1, E.7); external access only via the funder, FOIPPA/PIPA process, or legal demand through the ED

5. Transfers, Closure, and Holds

Placement transfer / discharge	PC prepares the transfer package per SHSS E.6 and ECC-MED §34; originals of the service record are retained/transferred per funder direction; a transfer inventory is signed by both parties
Program closure	All service records are delivered to the funder (MCFD director / CLBC per contract) with a signed inventory; nothing is destroyed in a closure
Litigation / investigation hold	On notice of any claim, investigation, licensing action, or request from counsel: the ED declares a hold in writing; all destruction stops for affected records until released in writing

6. Destruction Procedure (permitted records only)

What may be destroyed	ONLY records whose retention period has expired AND that are not service records, not under hold, and not required by the funder
Authorization	PC lists eligible records on the Destruction Log; PM verifies against the schedule; ED signs the authorization BEFORE destruction
Method	Cross-cut shredding or certified destruction service (certificate filed); electronic media securely wiped/destroyed; never regular garbage or recycling
Destruction Log	Records: description, date range, retention authority, destruction date, method, PC/PM/ED signatures; the log itself is permanent

7. Compliance Calendar — Records

Task	Frequency / DUE DATE	DATE DONE	INITIALS
Service record audit against SHSS E.7.10 contents (PM)	Quarterly		
Archive index updated; new closed records boxed	Quarterly		
Retention schedule review; destruction-eligible list prepared	July annually		
ED-authorized destruction executed and logged	July annually		
Records portion of policy suite review; version re-signed	July 1 annually		
Breach/incident review: any record loss events analyzed	Annually + per event		

Approval & Acknowledgement

Executive Director — Signature / Date	
Program Manager — Signature / Date	
Staff acknowledgement — captured via ECC-STAFF-BND-2026-001 Part 9	